



Latin 1

COURSE 0706300 • GRADES 8–9 • HIGH-SCHOOL CREDIT • TWO SEMESTERS • OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE — FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. It was drawn from one section of the course as taught this year, and each teacher leans into their own strengths and passions — so scholars may see some variation in activities, projects, and pacing from section to section, and between the live school and On-Demand. The structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

What this course is: A first-year high-school Latin course that pairs grammar with the great authors of the classical world. Students build their grammar from a standing reference library (the Grammar and Vocabulary Archives), then spend the year reading and responding to real classical literature: Homer's *Odyssey*, Cicero's speeches and rhetoric in Semester 1; Caesar's *Gallic War*, Plutarch, and the Stoic essays of Seneca in Semester 2. A weekly **etymology** thread connects Latin roots to the English words students use every day.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

Start	Course opener; how to use the Grammar, Vocabulary & Digital-Tools archives; intro to etymology
Sem 1	The <i>Odyssey</i> : Ulysses, the Trojan War, the Lotus-eaters & Polyphemus — with grammar (prepositions, cases) woven in
Sem 1	Cicero & Roman rhetoric: <i>De Oratore</i> , Rostra week (deliver a speech), passage analysis, invective & encomium • Quizzes 1 & 2
Sem 2	Julius Caesar & the <i>Gallic War</i> ; Plutarch and ancient biography • biography writing exercise
Sem 2	Translation week; the two Senecas — <i>On the Shortness of Life</i> and on old age
Finish	Hermeneutics (the art of interpretation), wrap-up weeks • End-of-Year Assessment

THE REFERENCE LIBRARY

- **Grammar Archive** — 22 always-available pages covering pronunciation, all declensions, conjugations, cases, pronouns, and adjectives.
- **Vocabulary Archive** — master vocabulary lists and memory work.
- **Digital Parsing & Translation Aids** — curated online dictionaries and parsing tools students learn to use like a classicist.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- **A reading or passage study** from the current author (Cicero, Caesar, Seneca...)
- **1–2 etymology assignments** tracing Latin roots into English
- **A grammar, translation, or reflection exercise** on the passage
- The **archives** serve as the student's reference shelf throughout
- Periodic **review weeks, quizzes**, and a quarter survey

TIME COMMITMENT

≈4 hours per week (250 minutes — about 50 min/day, M–F)

Readings & passage study ≈1½ hr • written assignments & translation ≈1½ hr • etymology & vocabulary ≈1 hr

Per-part split is an estimate; the 250-minute weekly total comes from the school's course plan. Writing and translation weeks may run longer.

WHAT STUDENTS NEED

- A computer with access to Canvas (all work is submitted there)
- Free online Latin dictionaries/parsing tools (linked inside the course)
- No textbook purchase required — readings are provided in the course

On-Demand (asynchronous): This overview describes the self-paced experience the course is designed for — students work through lessons on their own schedule with an Optima teacher available for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school: Students enrolled in the live virtual school take this same course in VR every school day with a teacher and classmates.